

# The Method Works

## Studies on Language Change in Honor of Don Ringe

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# South Oscan κλοπουστ (with an Appendix on [Osco-?]Lat. BVRVS)

Brent Vine

## 1 Introductory

**1.1**. South Oscan κλοπουστ is one of several 3sg. fut. perf. forms in a fragmentary law code from Roccagloriosa (ST Lu 62; ImagItal Buxentum 1), discovered in 1999 and first published in 2001 (Gualtieri & Poccetti, 2001). Given the dates of discovery and publication, the form is absent from Untermann (2000), as well as from the list of Sabellic perfect forms compiled by Piwowarczyk (2011: 117–123, explicitly based on Untermann).[1]

The text uses scriptio continua, whence an indeterminacy with the reading of the phrase in question. Like the rest of the text, the line containing this form (side A, line 7) is broken at both the left and right margins, and reads as follows: ]σταυτιαfκλοπουστ[. This is interpreted

[1] The form is also not registered in EDLIL, for unclear reasons.

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by Rix (ST ) as ]στ αυτ ιαf κλοπουστ[, whereas Crawford et al. (ImagItal ) offer ]στ αυτ ιαfκ [κ]λοπουστ[, with the annotation 'κ omitted on bronze'. In other words, directly preceding κλοπουστ (or [κ]λοπουστ) we would have the third person pronoun (acc. pl. fem.), either without (as ιαf, Rix) or with (as ιαfκ, Crawford et al.) the final deictic particle -κ; cf. Umb. **eaf**, *eaf* vs. Marruc. *iafc*. There is no clear consensus: thus [κ]λοπουστ is registered by Zair (2016: 204), evidently following ImagItal, while ιαf κλοπουστ is given by McDonald & Zair (2012: 36), as well as Dupraz (2009: 113).[2] For expository convenience we will operate with … ιαf κλοπουστ[, but there is no essential difference in what follows between κλοπουστ and [κ]λοπουστ.[3]

**1.2**. The interpretation of the form in context is generally agreed upon, as is its etymology: 's/he will have stolen these (fem. pl.)', with the Oscan verb a cognate of Gk. κλέπτω and Lat. *clepō* 'steal' (among other cognate material), based on PIE **klep-*.[4] While the suffix morphology is normal, with the standard Sabellic fut. perf. formant /-us-/ (plus 3sg. desinence),[5] there is an interesting anomaly in the root vocalism of this hitherto (as of 1999) unknown (and still largely unnoticed) Oscan perfect-system verb form: as noted by McDonald & Zair (2012: 36[3]), '[t]he combination of *o*-grade and non-reduplication in this verb … requires explanation.' This is the problem addressed in this paper. There are two previous solutions, both in my view problematic; following critiques of those proposals (in §§2, 3), I will offer (in §4) my own attempt at solution. (The Appendix following §4 expands on a point related to the proposal assessed in §3).

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[2] Dupraz (2009: 113[34]) suggests that the singleton ⟨κ⟩ may do double duty for both ιαfκ and κλοπουστ, and this may be correct; gemination is licit in South Oscan orthography, but generally associated with palatalization (Zair, 2016: 112–125), which would not be a factor here.

[3] For further discussion of the problem, see Martzloff (2021a: 202). It will be convenient to reserve for treatment below a rather different interpretation of the sequence.

[4] In addition to ImagItal (ad loc.), see already Gualtieri & Poccetti (2001: 222) for the etymology, followed by McDonald & Zair (2012: 36).

[5] Orthographic ⟨ου⟩ for /ŭ/ is not problematic: in this text, '/u/ from any source is spelt ⟨ου⟩ in any position in the word' (Zair, 2016: 70, further 63–79 and 86 on /u/ in South Oscan orthography).

## 2 Previous Solution #1: Root Aorist Relic

**2.1**. McDonald & Zair (2012: 36[3]) offer (somewhat tentatively, as a 'possible answer') the following two-part solution. PIE **klep-*, they suggest, may have formed a root aorist, with zero-grade weak stem **kl̥p-*, which would develop regularly to pre-Osc. **kolp-*. This form **kolp-*, however, was then remodeled to **klop-* after the present stem **klep-* (as in Lat. *clepō* 'steal'). This is ingenious and difficult to rule out; yet objections can be raised, most of them already anticipated by McDonald & Zair.

**2.2**. As for the assumption of a root aorist with zero grade: they acknowledge (citing Meiser, 2003: 103–104, 162) that 'original root aorists normally preserve full- rather than zero-grade in the root in Italic.' They claim, however, that 'this is not always the case,' as in Lat. *strāvī* 'I strewed', as well as relic forms like Lat. *parēns* 'parent' and *cliēns* 'client'. But these examples are not probative. In general, all Latin perfects with secure basis in a PIE root aorist (Weiss, 2020: 437–438; Lat. *līquī* 'I left', *fūgī* 'I fled', etc.) show full-grade roots, except *fuī* (OLat. *fūī*) 'I was' (cf. Ved. *ábhūt*, Gk. ἔφῡ), to a root notorious for displaying zero grades in full-grade contexts (Jasanoff, 1997).[6] There is, likewise, no Sabellic evidence for perfect stems based on the zero-grade allomorph of old root aorists; superficially possible instances have alternative explanations.[7]

**2.3**. Specifically for Lat. *strāvī*: this form is neither a 'root aorist' as such nor a form likely to continue a root aorist directly (of the type Lat. *līquī* etc.), but rather a '*v*-perfect'. The sources of Latin '*v*-perfects' are varied, and admittedly include root aorists in some cases; but here, Lat. *strā-* (the basis for the perfect stem *strā-v-*) is more likely analogical after the verbal adjective *strātus* (itself likely an inherited form < PIE **str̥h₃-tó-*, whence also Gk. στρωτός).[8]

[6] On such 'zero-grade roots' generally, see Vine (2022).

[7] E.g., Osc. *dicust* 'will have said' (cf. root aorist in Ved. *ádiṣṭa* 'showed') likely results from dereduplication (so *LIV*[2] s.v. 1. **deiḱ-*, n. 3; Meiser, 2003: 104); cf. Umb. *dersicust*.

[8] For this analysis of *strātus*, see *LIV*[2] s.v. **sterh₃-*, n. 4, following Meiser, and see now Meiser (2003: 228).

As for Lat. *parēns* and *cliēns*: these are, to be sure, likely relics of aorist active participles.[9] But such forms have little probative value for the issue at hand. While the original inflection of **-nt-* formations is a highly fraught problem, with amphikinetic patterning often assumed,[10] one may say that descriptively, purely verbal **-nt-* formations (as opposed to Caland **-nt-* formations) tend to display hysterokinetic features. In this sense, then, zero-grade root in the aorist active *participle* is virtually canonic,[11] with little bearing on an Italic (alleged) *finite* root aorist with zero grade root.

**2.4**. A more fundamental problem is that no other evidence supports the assumption of a root aorist for PIE **klep-*, which is generally reconstructed with an *s*-aorist, on the basis of Gk. ἔκλεψα and Lat. *clepsī* (as in *LIV*[2] s.v.; recently also Willi, 2018: 425[21]). McDonald & Zair offer the following rejoinder: 'The fact that Greek ἔκλεψα and Latin *clepsī* point to an *s*-aorist is not necessarily a problem, since these were productive in both languages (Oscan κλοπουστ would then be a relic).' This is possible in principle, but the situation is more complicated. As shown by Pike (2009), Lat. *clepō* also had a lengthened-grade perfect *clēpī*, attested in Pacuvius (*Hermiona* 185, ap. Nonius 20M = 30.15L), as well as Cicero (*Leg.* 2.22, in an archaic legal formulation). This may point to an acrostatic present **klḗp-ti* (which Pike supports via Tocharian material),[12] the imperfect of which was shunted into the Italic perfect system, as seems to have occurred in other cases (Weiss, 2020: 438–439, with references). Thus Osc. κλοπουστ, if interpreted as a root aorist relic, would not match *either one* of the two types of perfect formations for **klep-* that may have existed elsewhere in Italic.

**2.5**. Finally for this solution, one may also question the presumed remodeling of pre-Osc. **kolp-* to **klop-* after the present stem **klep-* (not

[9] So, e.gg., Meiser (2003: 46) and Weiss (2020: 464); and probably *trāns* 'across' (with its cognates) can be added to these (Vine, 2008: 20–21 with references).

[10] For discussion, see recently Lowe (2015: 311–314) and Willi (2018: 554 with n. 18).

[11] Cf. Ved. *diśánt-* beside *ádiṣṭa* (cited above, n. 7), *gmánt-* beside finite root aorist **g$^{w}$ém-t* in *ágan* and Osc. **kúmbened**, Arm. *ekn* to **g$^{w}$em-* 'come', etc.

[12] For Lat. *clēpī*: cf. TB *klep-* 'touch, test' (3sg. mid. *klyepträ* < **klḗp-e/o-* or **klḗp-tor* after **klḗp-ti*) < **'lay hand to'; in addition to Pike (2009), see also Adams (1989, 2013: 182–183 [s.v. *kälp-*], 186 [s.v. *kälyp-*], 246 [s.v. *klep-* and *klepe**]).

actually attested in Oscan, but cf. Lat. *clepō*). As McDonald & Zair note, this root is also attested in Osc. **kulupu** 'thieves' (gen. pl.) (ST Cm 14; ImagItal Cumae 8; cf. also Murano, 2013: 113–128), following Rix (ST), who interprets the form as based on the zero grade of a root noun (cf. Gk. κλώψ 'thief', -κλεψ in βοῦκλεψ 'ox-thief', and Lat. *cleps* 'fur' [CGL v 349.51]). I return to this form later; but for the present, it suffices to note that while PIE **klp*- did indeed regularly develop to Ital. **kolp*- (whence, with regular anaptyxis, O. **kulup**-), this **kolp*- —clearly based synchronically on a verbal idea 'steal'—did not undergo remodeling to **klop*-.

## 3 Previous Solution #2: Dereduplicated O-grade Perfect

**3.1**. As an alternative, McDonald & Zair cite the earlier (and entirely different) account of Osc. κλοπουστ by Dupraz (2009: 112–116), according to whom the form reflects a dereduplicated primary perfect stem, therefore with *o*-grade root (as is normal for the strong stem of PIE primary perfects). A brief digression, however, is in order here, to explain that Dupraz, in fact, adduces Osc. κλοπουστ in support of something else (the main subject of Dupraz, 2009), namely a form BVRVS, in a Latin inscription from North Oscan territory. This form is interpreted as (almost) the same type of form as Osc. κλοπουστ: i.e., a dereduplicated (and thematized) *o*-grade perfect participle. In my view, however, this interpretation of Lat. (or 'Osco-Lat.'?) BVRVS is highly uncertain, with the result that (despite Dupraz) Osc. κλοπουστ and BVRVS are not mutually supportive. Since, therefore, full discussion of the issues surrounding BVRVS—as interesting as they are—would take us too far afield, and to little purpose, that material is treated below in an Appendix. We can now assess the analysis of Osc. κλοπουστ as a dereduplicated primary perfect on its own terms.

**3.2**. It should first be pointed out that the semantics in question—'will have stolen—render Osc. κλοπουστ a poor candidate for an inherited stative perfect (as already noted by Dupraz himself [2009: 113–114]). Thus, if the form reflects a 'perfect', this is necessarily a post-PIE

innovative *o*-grade perfect, similar (e.g.,) to Gk. κέκλοφα (Aristoph.+).[13] This leads, in turn, to a general question as to the status of reduplicated *o*-grade perfects in Italic, where, in fact, such forms may not exist at all. In Latin, zero grade of the root has most often been generalized, or else the root vocalism of the present stem is used (see, e.g., Weiss, 2020: 435). The situation in Sabellic is essentially the same (Buck, 1928: 170–171; Meiser, 2003: passim).[14]

**3.3**. But even if one grants an original reduplicated perfect **ke-klop-* (for some stage of early Italic), we must ask whether such a form could have undergone dereduplication. This seems unlikely, given constraints on dereduplication in Italic, both phonological and morphological. Apart from the unusable comparison with (alleged) Osco-Lat. BVRVS (see above and, in much greater detail, the Appendix), Dupraz (2009: 112) compares the (alleged) dereduplication in κλοπουστ with that seen in OLat. *vortī* (1sg. perf.) and Umb. **kuvurtus**(**t**), *couortus*(*t*) (3sg. fut. perf.), both to **u̯ert-* 'turn'; but this is not actually supportive. If OLat. *vort-* and Umb. *-uort-* stem from an inherited primary perfect, such a form would show, in PIE terms, sg. **u̯e-u̯ort-* and pl. **u̯e-u̯r̥t-*. As it happens, however, both **u̯e-u̯ort-* and **u̯e-u̯r̥t-* would develop in Italic to **u̯ou̯ort-* (Meiser, 2003: 162); thus the 'dereduplication' here is essentially haplological, under these restricted phonetic circumstances (which would not be available for **ke-klop-*). At the very least, one must say that an actual old *o*-grade (as opposed to a zero grade) is not assured in any case as the basis for the Italic (unreduplicated) **u̯ort-*. Moreover, for Umb. **kuvurt-**/*couort-*, the preverb is perhaps another factor in the dereduplication; cf. the Latin type *repperī* 'I found', *rettulī* 'I brought back' (with syncope < **repeperī*, **retetulī*; Weiss, 2020: 436); cf. Class. *tulī* (vs. earlier *tetulī*; Leumann, 1977: 587), and comparable examples are probable for

[13] Predictably, under these circumstances, *LIV*$^2$ registers no PIE perfect for **klep-*.

[14] A few forms deviate from these patterns in a more or less idiosyncratic way: thus, for example, Pael. *pperci* 'she asked' shows a Schwebeablauting neo-*e*-grade beside Umb. **pepurkurent** 'they will have asked', with regular zero grade (< **pe-pr̥ḱ-*), to PIE **prḗḱ-*. (Some onomastic material may show the same innovation as Pael. *pperci*, as with Osc. **perkens**/**perkedne**[**ís**], **perkium**, on which see Zair [2021: 189, 191–192, 194–195].)

Sabellic.[15] This is registered as a final possibility for κλοπουστ by McDonald & Zair (2012: 36[3]): 'de-reduplication of κλοπουστ < **ke-klop-* may have been due to generalisation of a syncopated form found in compounds'. Indeed, Gualtieri & Poccetti (2001: 220–222) attempted to interpret the sequence ]…αυτιαfκλοπουστ[ (see §1 above) as ] … αυτι αfκλοπουστ[, with a compound verb αfκλοπουστ, rather than ] … αυτ ιαf κλοπουστ[, with a different form of the connective followed by a third person pronoun. This is technically possible, given the existence of Osc. αυτι/*auti* beside αυτ/**avt**; but it is not an attractive possibility. First, it would have the undesirable consequence of removing the direct object ιαf. Second, while an Oscan preverb **af-**/αf- may exist, it is found for the most part in a few very obscure items (**aflakus**, **aflukad**, **afstist**, αfλκειτ; see Untermann, 2000 s.vv.); thus, one should not have recourse to such a form lightly. Finally, Lat. *clepō* is entirely without preverb usage (and the same is true for Goth. *hlifan*); there is no serious support from Gk. ἀποκλέπτω 'steal away, run away with' (*hMerc.*+) or from OPr. *auklipts* 'concealed' and similar Baltic material (cf. Toporov, 1975: 149–150, s.v.). We may also mention, finally, the analogical type of dereduplication, based on related stems, as with Osc. *dicust* beside Umb. *dersicust* (cited above, n. 7): cf. Osc. **dadíkatted**, Lat. *dicārel dēdicāre* (Buck, 1928: 171). But there is no analogical basis for dereduplicated κλοπουστ.

**3.4**. For the sake of completeness, one further claim by Dupraz must be addressed, which he applies to all three forms that he regards as continuing Italic *o*-grade perfects (i.e., Osco-Lat. BVRVS, Lat. *uort-*, and Osc. κλοπουστ). According to Dupraz, these forms display a significant correlation with thematic presents (cf. **g$^{w}$érH-e/o-*, **u̯ért-e/o-*, **klép-e/o-*), with the *o*-grade perfects actually *derived from* the *e*-grades in some sort of ablaut relationship (2009: 114, 116), a process that is nevertheless unexplained. But there is nothing attractive about such a correlation, and one must agree with the evaluation of this claim by McDonald & Zair (2012: 36[3]), who write that this correlation would operate 'for unclear reasons'.

[15] Cf. Buck (1928: 171) on Umb. *procanurent* 'they will have sung'; similarly Untermann (2000: 366): 'Pf.-Stamm **kan-* oder wahrscheinlicher **kekan-*'.

**§3.5**. There is, to my knowledge, only one other possible *o*-grade perfect in Sabellic, namely Osc. ϝουρουστ 's/he will have found'—attested, as it happens, in the same text as κλοπουστ (side A, line 10; see McDonald & Zair, 2012 in detail). The interpretation as an *o*-grade perfect (i.e., sg. *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$e-$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$roh$_1$- / pl. *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$e-$\underset{\sim}{\mu}_{\text{̥}}$rh$_1$- > *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$ou$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$r-) is, in fact, McDonald & Zair's second option (2012: 35); but (despite some problematic issues, about which there is no space to comment further here) their first option is in my view superior, involving a reduplicated aorist *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$e-$\underset{\sim}{\mu}_{\text{̥}}$rh$_1$-*e*/*o*- (comparable to Gk. εὗρον and OIr. *-fúair* 'found').[16]

## 4 A New Approach. Osc. κλοπουστ as Denominative 'simple perfect'

**4.1**. In principle, a more satisfactory account of Osc. κλοπουστ would have a direct explanation for the root *o*-grade—in other words, an explanation that operates without the remodeling called for by the presumed (but questionable) basis in a root aorist, and without the dereduplication called for by background in a reduplicated primary *o*-grade perfect (which is itself a fragile construct for Italic). And in general, an *o*-grade verbal formation that cannot be aligned with primary *o*-grade verbal categories would be explicable in the simplest way via a nominal *o*-grade, as long as the verbal morphology is compatible with a denominative source. For example, an abstract *klop-éh$_2$ 'theft' (cf. Gk. κλοπή 'id.' [Aesch.+]) could produce an Italic denominative *klop-ā$\underset{\sim}{\text{i}}$e/o- 'engage in theft'; or a 'τομός form' *klop-ó- 'thieving, thief' (cf. Gk. κλοπός 'thief' [*h.Merc.*+]) could likewise yield an Italic denominative *klop-ā$\underset{\sim}{\text{i}}$e/o- 'steal'.[17] A denominative background, moreover, is perfectly natural for 'steal': see, for example, Rix (1985: 208–209) on VOL (s)ταταδ 'he shall steal' (< PIE *(*s*)*teh$_2$-i-* 'steal') in the Duenos Inscription (CIL i$^2$ 4), mainly replaced in the Classical language by the denominative *fūrārī* (based on the root noun *fūr* 'thief').

[16] Perhaps the root in question is not *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$reh$_1$- (as in *LIV*$^2$ and traditionally), but rather *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$erh$_1$- (so Willi, 2018: 77–78), which would exclude a perfect stem *$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$e-$\underset{\sim}{\mu}$roh$_1$-.

[17] While 'τομός forms' are rare in Italic, they are securely documented: see Weiss (2020: 292; Lat. *procus* 'suitor', *coquus* 'cook'), and for additional data, see Nussbaum (2017: 238[26]).

For a denominative background to be convincing, there are two further considerations to be faced. First is that the nominal forms just mentioned (**klop-éh₂*, **klop-ó-*) do not happen to be attested in Italic (although they could well have existed). In the ideal case, however, the *o*-grade nominal basis could be aligned with material that *is* attested in Oscan. Secondly, there is a 'big if' mentioned above, i.e., 'as long as the verbal morphology is compatible with a denominative source'. Yet, at first glance, this does not seem to be the case: Oscan denominatives should have *t*(*t*)-perfects, and these are abundantly attested, as in forms like **prúfatted**/πρωφατεδ 'probavit', **seganatted** 'signavit', **duunated** 'donavit', **teremnattens** 'terminaverunt', αφααματεδ 'iussit', Pael. *coisatens* 'curaverunt', and others, including the future perfect, as in **tríbarakattuset** 'aedificaverint'. Why, then, do we not see a form like †κλοπατουστ?

I now address these two considerations in turn.

**4.2**. The attested nominal form related to 'steal' is the root noun Osc. **kulupu** 'thief' (gen. pl.), as already seen (§2.5). While this form itself goes back to a zero grade **klu̯p-*, its background could well have included *o*-grade **klop-*, in view of the following considerations. First of all, according to the classic demonstration by Schindler (1972), the absolutely original form of (T)ReC- root nouns involves *ó*/*é*-acrostatic inflection; thus **klóp-*, obl. **klép-*, with nom. sg. **klóp-s* or (with analogical lengthened grade) **klṓp-s* (cf. Gk. κλώψ). Rix took the zero grade of Osc. **kulupu** to be decompositional (2002: 427); cf. Ved. *-tṛp-* as in (e.g.,) *paśu-tṛ́p-* 'cattle-stealing' (RV VII.86.5c, agreeing with *tāyú-* 'thief'), under the assumption of an Indo-Iranian root **trap-*, a deformed version of **krap-* < PIE **klep-*. Whether or not this analysis of Ved. *-tṛp-* is correct,[18] the zero grade in Osc. **kulupu** could, indeed, be decompositional. At the same time, however, *ó*/*é*-acrostatic root nouns often developed mobile inflection, with oblique-case zero grades (Schindler, 1972: 34–35). Thus, the Oscan root noun could, in principle, be based on a secondarily mobile form **klóp-*, obl. **klu̯p-´* of the root noun itself.[19] However that may be, one can point to a series of other replacement patterns (mainly post-PIE)

[18] Mayrhofer (EWAia i 635) is skeptical.

[19] My thanks to Tony Yates and Sasha Nikolaev for helpful discussion of this point. On the pattern of secondary (or 'emergent') mobility in the development of acrostatic formations, see recently Yates (2022).

for original *ó*/*é*-acrostatic root nouns, in addition to the patterns just described, including the following: generalization of *ō* (Gk. κλώψ, gen. κλωπός; Lat. *vōx*, gen. *vōcis* 'voice'); generalization of *ŏ* (Gk. [Hom.+] φλόξ, gen. φλογός 'flame'; κρόξ [Hsch.], acc. κρόκα [Hes. *Op.* 538] 'thread'); ablauting *ō*/*ŏ* (e.g., **u̯ōkʷ-*/**u̯ŏkʷ-*, cf. Lat. *vōx* vs. [denom.] *vŏcāre* 'call', Umb. *subocau*/*subocauu* 'I invoke' and *suboco* 'invocation').[20] Thus, the root noun continued in Osc. **kulupu** could imply the prior existence of an allomorph **klop-*, at some stage of Italic, on the basis of several possible scenarios; this **klop-* could then serve as the basis for a denominative verb **klop-āi̯e*/*o-* underlying Osc. κλοπουστ (though **klop-éh*$_2$ and/or **klop-ó-* could also have existed; see §4.1): e.g., survival for a time of an original acrostatic root noun **klóp-*/**klép-*, with **kulupu** decompositional; or post-PIE generalized **klop-* (of the type φλόξ), with **kulupu** decompositional; or post-PIE ablauting **klōp-*/**klop-* (of the type Lat. *vōx*/*voc-*), with **kulupu** decompositional; or (perhaps in the simplest way) post-PIE ablauting **klop-*/**kl̥p-* (as replacement for the original acrostatic root noun), with **kulupu** based on the weak stem and the strong stem **klop-* as basis for denominative **klop-āi̯e*/*o-*.

**4.3**. It remains to address the apparent conundrum of how a denominative **klop-āi̯e*/*o-* could produce an Oscan perfect stem that lacks both the stem-vowel *-ā-* and the characteristic *t*(*t*)-perfect suffix. Yet precisely such denominative-based perfects—i.e., suffixless and with *ā*-truncation (or *ā*-suppression)—are well-documented for Sabellic. There are, in fact, several subtypes of suffixless perfects in Sabellic,[21] of which the most prominent is that of *ā*-verbs (including denominatives) with suppressed or truncated *-ā-* in the perfect and lacking the characteristic *ā*-verb perfect suffix, i.e., *-t*(*t*)*-* in Oscan and *-nki̯-* in Umbrian: e.g., Osc. *urust* 'he will have declared' (which surely belongs with Lat. *ōrāre* 'speak, plead', thus an *ā*-verb), not †*uratust* (cf. **tríbarakattuset**; §4.1); Umb. *portust* 'he will have brought' (for its *ā*-verb status, cf. 2/3sg. impv. **purtatu**/*portatu*

[20] For Lat. *vocāre*, Umb. *suboc-* as based on the weak stem of an ablauting root noun, see, for example, Untermann (2000: 707) and EDLIL 692.

[21] For a good discussion, see Dupraz (2016: 344–345) on 'Die "einfachen Perfekta" des Sabellischen', with earlier references (to which add García-Castillero, 2000: 228[219]).

and 3sg. pres. subj. *portaia*), not †*portan̓sust* (cf. a regular denominative perfect like Umb. *combifian̓sust* 'he will have communicated'). One set of forms is particularly prominent, namely suffixless /ops/- and /ōps/- perfects based on denominative **op*(*e*)*s-āi̯e*/*o*- 'make, build':[22] Osc. 3sg. perf. **úpsed** and **upsed**, 3pl. **u**(**u**)**psens**, ουπσενς, Vestin. *ośens*; SPic. **opsút** and [**o**]**psúq**.

There are many questions surrounding these suffixless Sabellic perfects with *ā*-truncation, including the origin of the formation, why it appears for the limited set of verbs in question, and the explanation for the long-vowel /ōps/- forms. None of this can be explored here, except to mention, first, the fundamental treatment by Rix (1993) and some more recent discussions (e.g., Piwowarczyk, 2011: 110–111; Fortson, 2017: 850; Willi, 2018: 453[86], 491[205]), especially the detailed account by Lipp (2021: 299–301, 308–318; in briefer compass 2022: 506). Further, Lipp's proposal that the formation has an analogical origin based in imperfects (rather than perfects) seems promising; and, in my view, he convincingly refutes Rix's conception of the /ōps/- forms (followed by *LIV*[2] s.v. 1. **h*$_3$*ep*- with n. 3) according to which these are based on an inherited *s*-aorist. But the fundamental point for present purposes is the fact that this pattern is firmly established for Sabellic, authorizing the proposal offered here that Osc. κλοπουστ owes its *o*-grade to a denominative **klop-āi̯e*/*o*-, recovering the pattern seen in **ōr-āi̯e*/*o*- ~ Osc. *urust*, **por*-(*e*)*t-āi̯e*/*o*- ~ Umb. *portust*, and **op*(*e*)*s-āi̯e*/*o*- ~ Osc. **úpsed**. It can be mentioned, finally, that there is good typological support from Greek for 'denominative perfects', as explored in a fundamental treatment by Ringe (1984: 428–433) and more recently by Hackstein (2002: 166–167) in his analysis of the 'ad-hoc Denominativperfekt' in Hom. συνοχωκότε (*Il.* 2.218).

[22] Cf., for the *ā*-verb status, Osc. gerund **úpsannúm**, Umb. 3 sg. impv. *osatu*, Pael. 3 (sg. or pl.) impf. subj. *upsaseter*, among other Sabellic material, in addition to Lat. *operārī* 'work, take pains'. A particularly interesting—but problematic—form of this type is SPic. **o̯pesa̯**[ ]**úom**: for the difficulties concerning the reading, see recently Fortson (2017: 850) and especially Lipp (2021: 314 with further references), the latter with discussion of the possibility that the form (if it belongs with other **op*(*e*)*s-āi̯e*/*o*- material) may reflect a stage of the language with medial syncope *in statu nascendi*, a perspective developed for South Picene in Lipp (2021).

## 5 Appendix: (Osco-?)Latin BVRVS

The title of Dupraz (2009) refers to a 'North Oscan participle *burus*'. In reality, however, there is no such 'North Oscan' form; rather, there is a form BVRVS attested in a Latin inscription (CIL i$^2$ 3253, 1st c. BCE) from Superaequum, in North Oscan (more specifically Paelignian) territory. The published version of the text is as follows:

L . SELVS . C . F
HERCOLO
DONVM
DAT . BVRVS

A trivial correction (see Dupraz, 2009: 106 for details) concerns SELVS, an error (perhaps having arisen in the original reading of the damaged stone, which is now lost) for SEIVS, a well-attested gentilicium of an important family in the area; the text can thus be read as *L*(*ucius*) . *Seiu̯s* . *C*(*ai*) . *f*(*ilius*) | *Hercolo* | *donum* | *dat* . *burus*. This simple formulaic dedicatory text is easily interpretable as 'Lucius Seius, son of Gaius, gives a gift to Hercules …', apart from the mysterious final word BVRVS.

The simplest explanation takes the form as a cognomen BVRVS, representing *Burrus* (Enn. *Ann.*+), the Latinized version of Gk. Πῦρρος 'Pyrrhus'.[23] This is the position taken by both Vetter and Buonocore (see Dupraz, 2009 for the references), and held also by Paolo Poccetti (p.c., 19 January 2022). To this, however, Dupraz reasonably queries (2009: 107) why a cognomen should be positioned at the end of the text. For Vetter: the cognomen of L. Seius would have been added later; but this is highly unusual (as Vetter himself admitted), and there is no other indication that this word belongs to a different period from the rest of the text. For Buonocore: this is not the cognomen of L. Seius, but rather the cognomen of someone else, whose nomen, gentilicium, and patronymic are all missing; but (as Dupraz pointedly objects) it is unclear why all this material is missing, with the cognomen placed at the end of the text. And if we are dealing with a single text referring

[23] On *Burrus* with /b/: cf. already Quintilian 1.14.15, and further Biville (1990: 283).

to more than one grammatical subject (i.e., L. Seius and a separate personage BVRVS), why is DAT singular?

The goal of Dupraz (2009), then, was to explore an alternative already suggested in CIL ad loc. ('an vox Osca?'), given the facts that (1) the inscription is in Paelignian (i.e., North Oscan) territory, (2) the archeological context probably involved worship of Hercules, and (3) the name of Hercules in the text (i.e., HERCOLO) actually shows an Oscan feature, namely *o*-stem inflection (vs. the Latin consonant stem *Herculēs*), cf. Osc. dat. sg. **hereklúí**, Vestin. *herclo*. More specifically: in terms of standard votive phraseology in Latin, *donum dat* is often followed by *libens* 'willing(ly)' or *libens merito* 'willing(ly) [and] deservedly' (with reference to the service rendered to the divinity and the expected divine favor), while the (roughly) corresponding Oscan phraseology involves a phrase *brateis datas* (gen. sg.), elliptical for **bratom* (neut.) *brateis datas* 'thanks for favor rendered'. Dupraz reasons, then, that the Latin inscriptional sequence DAT . BVRVS may somehow be equivalent to Osc. *brateis datas*; i.e., BVRVS could mean 'grateful(ly)', based on PIE **gʷerH-* 'show approval, express agreement, etc.' (the source of Osc. *brat-* and Lat. *grāt-*, as well as Ved. *gṛṇáti* 'praise' and other material).[24] The specific morphological proposal is that BVRVS continues a (dereduplicated) perfect active participle **gʷorH-u̯ōs* (with *o*-grade root), which was then thematized as **gʷorH-u̯o-*, whence pre-Osc. **boru̯os* and then Osco-Lat. †*borus*. (I return below to the further development of †*borus* to *burus*.) For the thematized perfect active participle, Dupraz appositely compares Osc. nom. sg. *sipus* and Volsc. abl. sg. *sepu* 'knowing(ly)' < **sēp-u̯o-*, a thematized version of an original perfect active participle **sēp-u̯ōs* (for the root, cf. Lat. *sapiō* 'taste, understand').[25]

The 'vox Osca' idea as developed by Dupraz is intriguing and clever, and has recently been accepted by Martzloff (2021b: 352); but the morphology is very problematic, as Dupraz admits to some extent. PIE

[24] On Osc. **brateís**, *brateis*, *bratom*, etc. 'thanks, favor' = Lat. *grāt-* as in *grātēs* 'thanks', *grātia* 'favor, service, thanks' < **gʷr̥h₂-t-* (cf. verbal adjective *grātus* 'pleasing, thankful, deserving thanks'), see Rix (2000). For a possible reflex of this material in an early British divine epithet, see recently Prósper & Medrano (2022: 15–16).

[25] More recently, Martzloff (2021b: 350–351) has argued that only Volsc. *sepu* reflects a thematized version, while Osc. *sipus* continues a bona fide (unthematized) perfect active participle.

*$g^{w}erH$- (not surprisingly, given its semantics) did not make a perfect in PIE;[26] thus a perfect to this root in Italic would be an innovation, which lacks support otherwise in Italic. Moreover, as we have seen (§3.2 above), actual *o*-grades are all but unattested for Italic primary perfects (as opposed to zero grades and occasional *e*-grades, or carry-overs from present-stem vocalism), and dereduplication in Italic is highly constrained (§3.3). There is also a phonological problem: the expected outcome of Dupraz's pre-Osc. **boru̯os* for Latin-alphabet Oscan (with Latinized desinence) would be †*borus*, not *burus*; to address this, Dupraz appeals to a pre-/r/ raising process documented for Umbrian, but this is problematic, as we will see below.

What, then, is the solution for the odd (or at least oddly positioned) form BVRVS in this text? Can the cognomen idea be salvaged? Poccetti, for one, thinks so—as he remarks (p.c.), '[t]he final collocation of the *cognomen* could emphasize the status of Roman citizen.' Still, it is tempting to consider a different morphological version of the 'vox Osca' approach involving PIE *$g^{w}erH$- and Dupraz's interesting idea of comparing DAT . BVRVS and Osc. *brateis datas.* I suggest that BVRVS could continue a 'τομός form' *$g^{w}orH$-*ó*-; such forms are typically agentive and often develop as adjectives—the sense here would thus be 'expressing agreement/approval/thanks etc.', hence 'thankful(ly), grateful(ly)', precisely as appropriate for the context.

Several points can be added to this suggestion. First, although τομός forms are somewhat rare in Italic (as opposed to τόμος forms), they are attested with certainty (as already seen in §4.1). Second, it is interesting to observe that τομός forms to this root are actually attested in Vedic (no doubt independently): note, e.g., the dual dvandva *abhigarāpagarau* (KS XXXIV.5 (39.1)), reflecting *abhigara-* + *apagara-*, roughly 'one who praises' + 'one who blames'.[27] Finally, to return to the phonological

[26] Ved. *saṃjagára* (YV) is a Neubildung (*LIV*² s.v. *$g^{w}erH$-).

[27] Similar contexts for *abhigara-* and *apagara-* include PB V.5.13 and XXV.15.3. Likewise, *abhigará* (dual) at MS I.9.1 (131: 11) refers to two priestly figures, and is also most easily compatible with agentive meaning. Some related material (such as Ved. [TS, AB, ŚB] *pratigará-* 'response') seems to involve action nouns (i.e., a 'τόμος form'); but both types of compounds with preverb (agentive *abhigará-*, action noun *pratigará-*) regularly show oxytone accentuation (AiG ii/2 §31a, pp. 98–99). Warm thanks to Stephanie Jamison for assistance in evaluating the Vedic material.

problem mentioned above: a τομός form PIE *$g^{w}$*orH-ó-s* should develop to pre-Osc. **boros*, whence **bors* (with regular final-syllable syncope) and then †*bor* (with absorption of **-rs* and degemination of **-rr*; see Meiser, 1986: 59–60, 154). However, the *o* > *u* raising process to which Dupraz appealed is, in fact, best attested not before /r/ (as Dupraz states, 2009: 110), but rather before the clusters /rn/, /rf/, and /rs/ (Meiser, 1986: 115–116); thus, here we would actually predict **bors* > †*bur*. At this point, an echt-Oscan (but fatally opaque, in a Latin context) †*bur* could have been trivially repaired as *burus* (with transparent nom. sg. masc. desinence, agreeing with *L. Seius*). Alternatively, *$g^{w}$*orH-ó-s* could have developed regularly to Osc. **bur** (in pre-spelling-reform orthography); and, as Martzloff plausibly suggests (2021b: 352–353), this version of the word (or a recollection of it) may be what underlies the spelling of the repaired BVRVS in the Latin context of the inscription.

In the final analysis, one cannot press the τομός-form suggestion too far, and perhaps the cognomen interpretation remains worth considering. But the salient point for present purposes is that a deredupulicated perfect participle with *o*-grade (based on a primary perfect) is a questionable source for Lat. (or Osco-Lat.?) BVRVS.[28]

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[28] I am happy to have the opportunity to offer this modest contribution to Don Ringe, as a token of longstanding friendship and admiration, and in emulation—however imperfect—of his characteristic erudition and methodological rigor. Previous versions of this paper were presented at meetings of the Graduate Seminar of the UCLA Program in Indo-European Studies (January and May 2022) and at the 41st East Coast Indo-European Conference (June 2022, Harvard University). I am grateful to the audiences on those occasions, as well as to Olav Hackstein, for helpful comments and criticism, and I take full responsibility for errors of fact or interpretation that may, despite their best efforts, persist in this version.

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